

MARS

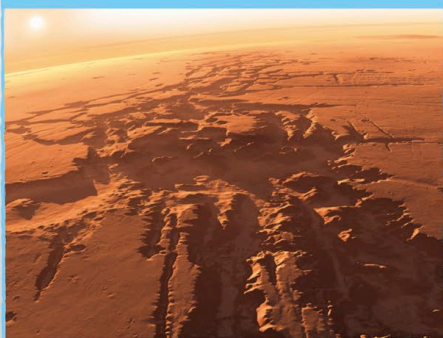


Mars, known as the Red Planet, is the world that most resembles our Earth. It is red, because it is, literally, rusty – from oxygen in the air reacting with iron minerals. Liquid water may still be present on Mars, leading to speculation that there is primitive life on the planet. Mars has been visited by several rovers, and orbiting spacecraft, and there are plans for humans to travel there by the 2030s.

Mars' surface is an endless desert of sand and rock

Giant volcano Olympus Mons is three times taller than Mount Everest

CANYON SYSTEM



Valles Marineris is a huge canyon system on Mars, created by volcanic activity in the Tharsis region that caused the planet's surface to crack apart. The gash is so vast that you could fit Earth's Alps inside it. It is 7 km (4 miles) deep and 4,000 km (2,480 miles) long; ten times longer than America's Grand Canyon.